



Dundee Sailing and Rowing Club

June 2026 Newsletter

Yolanda Archibald

9th June 2026

Commodore's Corner

Firstly, a very warm welcome to all the new members who have joined the club recently. It's great to see so many new faces getting involved, and I hope you're enjoying being part of the club both on and off the water. We have welcomed people from a variety of sailing and rowing backgrounds, including, some who have brought their own boat along to join us on the water, which is great to see.

It's been great to see the club so active, with sailing and rowing, training and regatta all keeping members busy. The Thursday sailing sessions have really taken off, with lots of boats on the water and a great mix of experienced members and newcomers getting involved. While the weather hasn't always been on its best behaviour – here's hoping for a summer filled with sailing, rowing, laughter and lots more time on the water.

Everyone Has Something to Offer

One of the great things about our club is that everyone brings something different to it. Some members are sailors, some are rowers, some enjoy both, and many skills and experience that help keep the club running on and off the water.

If you're a new member and have skills or experience in areas such as woodworking, fibreglass repairs, painting, joinery, engineering, electrics, or other trades, we'd love to hear from you. It doesn't mean you're signing up for a full-time job! But it's always helpful to know who we might be able to call on occasionally for advice or a helping hand.

The club only works because members share their time, skills and experience, and every contribution — large or small — is greatly appreciated.

Open Day – 9th May

Wow, what a day it turned out to be! The club was buzzing and the wind kept everyone on their toes. A huge thank you to everyone who helped take visitors sailing and rowing, managed the stalls, helped with registration and kitting out - it was an outstanding success. It was fantastic to see so many visitors enjoying both sailing and rowing. We were also lucky to capture some wonderful photographs and video footage from the day, helping preserve some great memories. A special mention must go to young Pavel, who worked throughout the day helping with the teas and coffees.

A special thank you to Martin Groves, who kindly brought along his drone and captured some amazing aerial footage of the sailing boats and skiffs out on the water. The views from above really showed the club at its very best.

Many thanks also to Murray, who spent much of his time in the water helping boats launch and recover that we're considering charging him harbour dues! 😊 It certainly didn't go unnoticed and was a huge help in keeping everything running smoothly.

The stalls were another great success, raising an incredible £510 for the club. A huge thank you to the party planners and everyone who donated items and supported the day in so many ways. It really was a fantastic team effort and shows what can be achieved when everyone pulls together.

It looks as though somewhere between 45 and 52 people took to the water during the day, which is a fantastic result. Even better a number have since joined – so great result all round.

Regatta – Broughty Ferry Rowing – 30th May

The Broughty Ferry Regatta on 30th May was a great day out, with DSRC rowers taking part in five races. While we didn't come home with any medals this time, and if you want to know what actually happened in the ladies' race, they certainly won the award for "Most Through Warm Up". In fact, we were working so hard getting ready that Broughty Ferry went ahead and started the race without us. As their cox, I take full blame for the scheduling mishap, but our crews should be incredibly proud of themselves, especially as some of our rowers were taking part in their very first regatta.

The teams have been training hard for only 6 weeks, with early morning rows, evening sessions and plenty of miles covered along the way. Thankfully there were also plenty of laughs, encouragement and good banter mixed in with all the hard work!

A big thank you to Royal Tay for organising such a well-run event and for making us so welcome. Most importantly, everyone enjoyed the experience.

Work Party – 6th June

Another productive working party saw more work achieved around the club. One of the Johns, together with helpers, tackled the dinghy parks, moving boats and cutting the grass underneath and around them, which made a real difference to the appearance of the site. Meanwhile, the other John and team were busy carrying out work on our former Commodore's John's dinghy. With so many Johns involved, we were beginning to lose track of which John was which. 😊

More progress was also made on the slipway thanks to the effort of Clive and Paco, while David, Katja, Murray and another willing volunteer rolled up their sleeves to tackle the sanding and painting on the west side of the building. Two coats of blue later, the clubhouse was looking for much fresher, and thankfully there were very few blue volunteers by the end of the day.

A big thank you to everyone who came along and lent a hand. It's amazing what can be achieved when people roll up their sleeves and work together. Judging by the amount we got done, imagine what we could achieve with a few more pairs of hands next time.

Row Across the Atlantic Talk - 3rd June

One of the highlights of the past week was undoubtedly our evening with Nicky Matthews, who shared the remarkable story of rowing across the Atlantic. What an inspiration she was. Listening to Nicky speak, it was impossible not to be amazed by what can be achieved when someone sets themselves a goal and is determined to see it through, no matter what challenges lie in the way.

Nicky brought the adventure to life with honesty, humour and plenty of memorable stories. From learning how to repair damage to the boat in the middle of the ocean, to coping with the realities of life aboard a tiny rowing boat, and even going over the side — securely attached by rope 😊 — to clear barnacles from the hull, it was a fascinating insight into a world few of us will ever experience. What struck me most was the resilience, teamwork and sheer determination needed to keep going day after day, mile after mile, across more than 3,000 miles of open ocean.

A huge thank you to Nicky for giving up her time to come and speak to us, and to Karen H. for organising such a wonderful evening. It was uplifting, inspiring and a powerful reminder that extraordinary things can be achieved by regular folk like us who dare to dream big and then have the courage to follow those dreams.

Power Boat & Safety Helm Refresher Courses

We have five members taking part in the upcoming Power Boat and Safety Boat refresher courses. As well as building on existing experience and developing confidence on the water, the training will provide more members with the skills needed to helm club boats and support activities in the future.

A Reminder about the Clubhouse Cleaning Rota

The rota is on the noticeboard upstairs at the top of the stairs, and there are still plenty of spaces available. If everyone takes a turn, it makes the job much easier for everyone and keeps the club looking good.

Team up with another member and put your name down. New members are very welcome too, and if you're not sure what's involved, just ask a member and they'll point you in the right direction and happy to show you the ropes.

Please have a look next time you're at the club and see if you can claim a slot. Many hands really do make light work! 😊

Club Outside Noticeboard

A big thank you to Kerstin, for giving the club noticeboard a refresher. So next time you are passing by, have a wee look. The noticeboard is also a great way of letting passers-by see what the club is all about.

If anyone has a flair for keeping things looking good and showcasing it for club visitors and passers-by and keeping everything fresh and up to date, please step forward 😊.

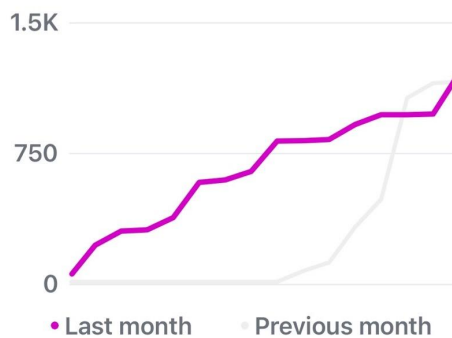
Suggestion Box

We're always happy to hear new ideas, if there's something you'd like to see happening at the club, or you have a suggestion that might improve things, please pop a note in the suggestion box upstairs in the club. New ideas are always welcome!

Social Media Update

Thanks to Mandy and the team for keeping our social media pages active and up to date. The figures below just how many are seeing and engaging with our posts. Who knew a few photos and videos could travel so far! 😊

Reel and post views last month



📌 You shared 3 more reels than the previous month, which helped improve your views.

Dates to Be Noted

- Midsummer Sailing with camping at Perth - Weekend 20-21st June
- Forfar Fun Regatta – Saturday 20th June
- Fifie Friday – North Queensferry 26th June
- TEWSH/Gala Day Regatta (sailing and rowing) – Sunday 5th July
- Portsoy Trip – 25-28th August
- DSRC Beach Bonfire Night, live music with the Doolichters in the boathouse – Saturday 29th August
- Forfar Regatta – Saturday 17th October

A reminder to keep an eye on our WhatsApp groups, where rowing training sessions and other opportunities are regularly being posted. Also sailors please keep an eye on Spond for your weekday and weekend sails.

Further longer trips can be found on the club calendar and sailing programme.

Until next time, keep the water on the outside of the boats, the paint on the woodwork,
and try not to lose track of which John is which!

Yolanda

Contact: yvarchibald@gmail.com

